

The settings that you can use in the *policies.json* file are described at <https://github.com/mozilla/policy-templates/>.

The customised *policies.json* file that I use is available at <https://gist.github.com/vsubhash/>.

```
{
  "policies": {
    "DisableAppUpdate": true,
    "DisableBuiltinPDFViewer": true,
    "DisableFirefoxStudies": true,
    "FirefoxHome": {
      "Search": false,
      "TopSites": false,
      "Highlights": false,
      "Pocket": false,
      "Snippets": false,
      "Locked": true
    },
    "DisableFirefoxAccounts": true,
    "DisableFirefoxStudies": true,
    "DisablePocket": true,
    "DisableTelemetry": true,
    "DisplayMenuBar": "always",
    "DontCheckDefaultBrowser": true,
    "Homepage": {
      "URL": "",
      "Locked": true,
      "StartPage": "none"
    },
    "ManualAppUpdateOnly": true,
    "NoDefaultBookmarks": true,
    "OverrideFirstRunPage": "",
    "OverridePostUpdatePage": "",
    "PDFjs": { "Enabled": false },
    "Permissions": {
      "Camera": { "BlockNewRequests": true, "Locked": true },
      "Microphone": { "BlockNewRequests": true, "Locked": true },
      "Location": { "BlockNewRequests": true, "Locked": true },
      "Notifications": { "BlockNewRequests": true, "Locked": true },
      "VirtualReality": { "BlockNewRequests": true, "Locked": true },
      "Autoplay": { "Default": "block-audio-video", "Locked": true }
    },
    "Preferences": {
      "browser.sessionstore.resume_from_crash": {
        "Value": false,
        "Status": "locked"
      },
      "browser.tabs.closeWindowWithLastTab": {
        "Value": false,
        "Status": "locked"
      },
      "dom.event.clipboardevents.enabled": {
        "Value": false,
```

```
        "Status": "locked"
      },
      "dom.event.contextmenu.enabled": {
        "Value": false,
        "Status": "locked"
      },
      "browser.search.suggest.enabled": {
        "Value": false,
        "Status": "locked"
      },
      "media.mediasource.enabled": {
        "Value": false,
        "Status": "locked"
      }
    },
    "NewTabPage": false,
    "SearchBar": "separate",
    "SearchSuggestEnabled": false,
    "UserMessaging": {
      "WhatsNew": false,
      "ExtensionRecommendations": false,
      "FeatureRecommendations": false,
      "UrlbarInterventions": false,
      "SkipOnboarding": false,
      "MoreFromMozilla": false
    }
  }
}
```

Let us examine the settings in this file.

Cookies

Cookies are text files that are created by websites that you visit and stored by the browser in your profile directory. They exist even after you close the browser. When you visit the site again, the browser will let the site read its cookie. Websites typically store your login details or your site preferences in the cookies. Cookies are not a problem if they were created by a site that you visited. When cookies are created by an advertising company like Google or Facebook, they can track your browsing habits. How does this happen? The sites that you visit are likely to run ads from Google, Facebook and other advertising companies. Thus, the cookie that was not created by the site you visited is a third-party cookie. It serves no purpose other than to track you.

You can block third-party cookies without losing any functionality. To be even safer, you can make Firefox clear all cookies when you close the browser. You may have to log in again when you visit a secure site but for that you can use the browser's built-in password manager. Firefox allows you to save your user names and passwords and will also autofill the login fields. Thus, the cookie's functionality is required